

Replace the number 5 with 3 to change the runlevel from GUI to Text-mode. Save the file and reboot the system. You will notice that the system now boots to a text mode (black back ground with white text).

The runlevel for system administration is 1. It is also called single user mode. It is rarely used (and should be that way). It is put into action only if there are problems encountered when booting into normal runlevels like 3 and 5. For example, if a change made in the X Window System configuration of a desktop has rendered the Graphic mode of the system unusable, then it is possible to temporarily boot into a console (either runlevel 1 or 3) and rectify the changes done to the X Window configuration files. Similarly, if a machine will not boot due to a damaged configuration file or has login problems because of a corrupted `/etc/passwd` file or because of a forgotten password, this problem can only be solved by booting into single-user mode (runlevel 1).

9.2.1 Select Important Services—Speed Up The Boot Process

Most of the new users install a particular distro and use it with all the default process running. Processes such as `pcmcia`, `nfs`, `sshd` etc. are not required on a home desktop machine; these processes are mainly used on a server and some can be used on a desktop if you have a small network environment. The normal boot process of Linux will start most of these unwanted processes resulting in a long wait. It is easy to turn these unwanted processes OFF especially on a Redhat based system.

Use the command `#chkconfig --list` to display the list of process and its status for levels 0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5 and 6. Of all these levels only 3 and 5 are concerned with desktop user operation. Instead of suggesting the processes to be disabled, we would rather tell to you the processes that are necessary for ideal operation. The essential processes are `anacron`, `crond`, `echo`, `gpm`, `keytable`, `network` (enable if the PC belongs to a network), `random`, `sendmail`, `sshd`, `syslog` and `xfs`. You may enable some more process if you think necessary, say for instance, `kudzu` is a hardware detection process that takes considerable time in the boot process; most of us don't open our